

BSc. Fashion Design and Marketing
HFD 101: Principles of Art and Design

THE GARMENT INDUSTRY

The garment industry is characterized by both micro, small, medium and large manufacturing firms. The businessperson with a good idea or ability to sell a product can capitalize on his talent and pay a small-business person to complete the manufacturing process. Almost all phases of production and selling can be contracted to small outside firms. This saves the creative businessperson from large investments in plant facilities and machinery. Additionally, small apparel firms tend to have more styling flexibility and more merchandising innovativeness. They can follow more trend quickly and pullout as the item saturates the market. Small firms specialize in serving a small group of retailers who want exclusive, more expensive styling.

A fashion designer is a creative professional who conceives and creates clothing, accessories, and footwear. Their personality is often a blend of artistic flair and business acumen. They are typically visionary, innovative, and highly passionate about aesthetics, constantly seeking inspiration from various sources like art, history, and current trends. A successful designer possesses a keen eye for detail and an unwavering commitment to quality.

The fashion designer must understand the production procedures of the factory. If the designer is to produce a garment compatible with the price range and technical limits of the production systems, they must understand the production process. This is especially important when selecting fabrics, the designer must recognize potential problems as they construct the garment sample the design room. Then his/her methods are passed on to the production person who modifies them for stock goods.

CONCEPTS OF DESIGN IN APPAREL DESIGN

The Concept of Clothing Design

The term design is a multidisciplinary concept, its meaning and use varies in the different fields. Design is a plan or drawing produced to show the look and function of a garment and accessory object before they are made. Fashion design is the art of applying design, aesthetics and natural beauty to clothing and its accessories. Clothing/fashion design is influenced by cultural and social attitudes and has varies over time and place.

Clothing is also known as **clothes, apparel, garments** and **attire**. It is a collective term for items worn on the body. Clothing can be made of textile and animal skin or other thin sheets of materials put together. The wearing of clothing is mostly restricted to human beings and is a feature of all human societies. The amount and type of clothing worn depend on body type/ shape, social- cultural behavior, and geographic considerations. Some clothing can be gender-specific (social construction of gender)...gender fluid

FASHION DESIGN AS A PRODUCT AND PROCESS

A. FASHION DESIGN AS PRODUCT

Clothing designs are man-made product falls into two major categories: sensory and behavioral design.

Sensory Design

Sensory design are products experienced through the physical senses: sight, sound, taste (psychology), touch, smell.

Q. what garment have you experienced these sensory aspects in design?

Albino, autistic, eczema cancer patients, autoimmune conditions, mental, GBV etc

Clothing for special groups.

Clothing fabric is felt on the outside as well as on the inside against the skin and is seen on the wearer. Occasionally experienced as sound, with the soft swoop of satin, the rustle of taffeta, the rubbing of corduroy, the cracking of leather, or the jangle of beads; or the smell of suede and leather goods or the fragrance of sandalwood beads.

Behavioral Design

Behavioral design deals with patterns of doing things, events or actions in time. This can be found in every area of human endeavor (activities), but most often involves the behavioral sciences of economics, sociology, psychology, religion, government (MAO suits), education, anthropology, law (sumptuary laws) and such activities as transportation, advertising, communications, time, use (category), and service industries. Every planned behavior is also a design product (cooking, swimming, nurse, soldier etc).

Characteristics that define the process of the fashion design industry.

There numerous/ various characteristics that define the fashion design industry process more inclusively to guarantee profitability/ success. Some of these are;

- i. It is consumer driven
- ii. It eliminates steps that do not add value to the end product
- iii. It defines the desired product through detailed standards and specifications _ Kenya Bureau Standard
- iv. Partners through a virtual supply chain that shares the responsibility and risk for producing the quality product needed.
- v. It is dependent on each partner's ability to meet schedules in order to deliver a product that reaches the market place when consumer are ready to buy.
- vi. It must lend itself to distribution through multiple channels (brick and mortar stores, internet and catalog)

FASHION DESIGN AS A CREATIVITY PROCESS

A realistic observation of needs and logical thinking order, removes great deal of the supposed "mystery" of design or "creativity". Getting ideas, however, is not so often a matter of inventing something totally new. It is using old things in new ways, or seeing the familiar in a new light by practicing it. GIVE EXAMPLES designing a dress, trouser or bag.

Design as a process is the planning and organizing done to meet goal carried out according to a particular purpose. As a product, it is the end result, an intended arrangement that is the outcome of that process or plan. The basic steps in fashion design are as follows:

1. Set the goal

Decide what the last result or product should be. The goal may be very broad and general, such as designing a garment or a wedding dress. Setting the goal focuses efforts that suggests a range of possible media and eliminates impossible and aimless paths. The clothing designer will consider flexible media, such as fabrics, fur, leathers, or plastics.

This generalized goal establishes a range of possibilities, eliminates irrelevances and suggests a direction of focus. A goal may be established at the onset or may arise out of inspiration or creative experimentation along the way.

Q. As a fashion designer what is the general goal in design a dress?

Theme, Occasion, profession, season, categories of clothes etc. (design brief..... oral / written best written)

2. Examine relevant outside influences

Outside influences are the things the designer must know (before the design is initiated) about the purpose, occasion, and users of the product and the circumstances in which it is to be used. They are the outside factors, which determine the development and final form of the clothing design.

The clothing designer must consider the likely user's age group, sex, size, weight, figure, preferences and budget. He or she must know the occasion of intended use, climate, season and availability of resources (fabric, fastenings, tailors, machines---outsource). If the work is custom/ bespoke (personal measurements are used to design a clothing) the customers' personal preferences, skin color, and other individual factors are known. But if the designer works for a commercial firm, which caters to a market of a particular size range, a price level or special occasion, then those will become the outside influences. They are what determine the characteristics the product must have to perform. E.G. Africa as a target market for Africa

Q. What are the characteristics of official/casual women's wear produced by a commercial firm? Color, shape, garment composition e.t.c

3. Establish Criteria

Specify what the product must and must not do to fulfill its purpose, according to needs determined by the relevant outside influences. The raincoat designer's relevant outside influences (wet, windy weather) suggest criteria that the product must keep the wearer dry yet allow air circulation

- i. Not be damaged by water
- ii. Withstand friction
- iii. Withstand strain and motion

- iv. Be easy to put on and take off
- v. Easy to care for
- vi. Be roomy enough to put over other clothing without being bulky; 3rd layer garment
- vii. Be attractive and the likeable.

An industry or governmental agents sets minimum acceptable performance standards (KEBS); in other cases functional criteria is voluntary. Clothing involves both voluntary and minimum acceptable performance standards ----meaning. For example, certain children's wear is required law to meet government flammability standards in fabric users (sleeping clothes and infant clothes) while its optional in some children's clothing categories.

Q. What are the set performance and voluntary standards of school uniform, backpack in Kenya? Any other standards you know of?

Once the goal is set, the relevant outside influences are examined and the criteria they suggest are established. Designing is already done and the range of choice is narrowed. This guarantees a successful design in clothing.

4. Make the plan

The designer selects the supplies (ingredients) and plans their use to give the product the right characteristics to perform, to meet the criteria, and fulfill its purpose. The plan is the recipe (elements) or formula (principles) to meet the criteria/goal. For clothing, the design plan answers the following questions:

- i. How will the garment function to meet its purpose? warmth, attraction, , protection, assimilation etc
- ii. Where will the openings be? For garment to function and fulfill its purpose? Buttons? Zippers? How will they work?
- iii. How will the designer provide for moving, ease stretching and bending? Ease and tolerance
- iv. What fit is intended and how will it be achieved? Close fitting or loose
- v. How will the structure of the garment relate to the structure of the body? Body shape Vs garment outline (silhouette)
- vi. What specific fabric will be used? What fiber content?
- vii. Textile give fabrics their character. E.g. cotton VS chiffon?
- viii. What linings will be used? Support fabrics- gum material or facing or quilting
- ix. Interfacings? What weight? Light VS heavy?
- x. Which of the elements and principles of visual and tactile design will be used and how? And why?

For example, a coat designer examining outside influences of winter season and cold climate sets warmth as a criterion. Plan of specifications might include long sleeves, wool for its insulating properties, and a high collar. Wise use of fabric textures, colors, line, shape, and other elements of design according to principles of design will show thoroughly the outside influences have been considered and will determine how well the criteria will be met for a successful product.

5. Carry out the Plan

Bringing the design from plan to reality. Clothing manufacturers make a sample (prototype) to ensure that the pattern specifications produce a result reflecting the designers' intentions (design sketch). Modifications needed can be done before volume production of the final design model is begun.

6. Evaluate the Product

The designer judges the characteristics and performance of the product by the criteria set to meet the goal. Does it fit? Is it comfortable? Does it wear well? Is it easy to care for? Do fasteners open and close easily and stay closed when they should? Are they placed to avoid gaps? Is there adequate provision for body movement and ease? Are the lines and colors flatter to the wearer? Does the garment meet special criteria, if any? Is the texture appropriate to its use? Is the manufacturing and retail cost in the line with its quality? This is done to evaluate a particular garment and to explore new ideas for future improvements.

CREATING GARMENT STYLES

The fashion designer is directly responsible to the head of company or division. He /she will work closely with the chief / head designer in choosing the fabrics and finalizing styles selected for the line or collection. The versions of designs from the last season may provide the basic styles of the new line. The designer may consider the following requirements as they sketch the actual garments.

- i. **Aesthetic appeal:** The garment design should be attractive to the specific customer for whom it is created (target consumer group). Every customer is looking for a stylish garment but the aesthetic requirement differ with every size, price, age range, social and cultural practices etc. The fabric should be visually attractive and fashionable in print and color, feel good to touch (hand - feel). The designer should create a garment that is easily accessorized yet is suitable for a range of activities making it easy to sell.
- ii. **Price:** The garment must have good value for the price. When the styling the garment the designer must consider the price of every detail, i.e. initial cost of fabric, trims, construction methods. Ultimately, the garments success or failure may depend on cost
- iii. **Timing:** The garment designs must be at the selling racks at the right time not too early or too late for the fashion taste of the moment. The designer must be aware of the fashion trends and factors that influence it. Therefore, the design must fit the general fashion trend and satisfy the customers desire to be unique and fashionable.
- iv. **Fit:** Once the customer has selected the garment and to try it on, the chance of selling the garment improves. The garment must look right on the customer's figure or body shape. The garment must conceal, figure problems, flatter the face and body, fit well and is pleasingly proportional it will be a success....i.e. garment that sells
- v. **Care and durability:** The customer may examine to see if the garment is well made i.e. seams, trims, fastenings etc. The garments should be easy to care for particularly wash and wear, making it a satisfactory garment. A satisfactory garment is one that performs well and looks beautiful. The garment should stand up to washing and ironing during the washing cycle. Usually the responsibility for garments performance is shared by production and design department. The choice of a wash and wear fabric for outer fabric and dry cleaned lining fabric for a garment design defeats the purpose and results in an unsatisfactory garment.
- vi. **Fabrications** means selecting or creating a style for fabric. Which fabric element is suitable for a specific style depends on the characteristics of fabrics:
 - a. Surface interest is the way a fabric looks – color, aesthetic, pattern and texture
 - b. Weight – correct weight for wear requirements, season and construction details e.g. summer dress/ coat

- c. Texture or hand (altered by finishes)– correct stiffness for the silhouette, fabric feels pleasant and drapes well
- d. Fiber – suited for the season, good performance and easy care and allergic reactions being rare

The elements of the fabrics will dictate the limit of styling. The designer is fabric sculptor and the human body is the frame of reference. The designer needs to experiment with natural and synthesis fabrics to gain more experience.

FUNDAMENTALS OF FASHION DESIGN AND ART

Fashion design is visual art; it's not only about making clothes. A fashion designer uses artistic principles to communicate ideas, moods, culture, personality, and creativity through clothing.

A good designer needs to understand how **color, line, shape, proportion, texture, space, movement, and form** work together. These elements help a designer create garments that are attractive, balanced, functional, and meaningful. These elements work together to communicate an idea, mood or personality through clothing.

Fashion interpretation: The process of studying and understanding a garment by looking at its visual qualities, construction, materials, proportions, and artistic expression.

A designer should be able to look at a garment and ask questions,

- i. What colours have been used and why?
- ii. How does the garment relate to the human body?
- iii. What type of fabric is being represented?
- iv. What is the overall silhouette?
- v. Are the proportions balanced?
- vi. How will the garment move when worn?
- vii. What feeling or message does the design communicate?

ANATOMY OF FASHION DESIGN

The anatomy fashion design refers to the different parts and features that make up a garment and how they work together in relation to the human body. The designer needs to understand where the body bends, where it carries volume and how clothing sits on it.

Garment anatomy is the identification and understanding of the individual parts of a garment and their relationship to the whole design.

Therefore, when changing the neckline, the fashion designer can completely change the character of a dress. A wide neckline may create an open appearance, while a high neckline may create a more formal or modest effect.

Understanding garment anatomy helps designers communicate ideas clearly and make accurate technical and fashion illustrations.

STRUCTURE OF THE HUMAN FIGURE IN FASHION ILLUSTRATION

Fashion designers draw clothing on the human body, so knowledge of anatomy is important.

The fashion figure is usually stylized and elongated compared with a normal human figure. This allows the clothing to be displayed clearly.

Important areas to understand include:

- i. Head and neck
- ii. Shoulders
- iii. Rib cage
- iv. Waist
- v. Hips

- vi. Arms and elbows
- vii. Hands
- viii. Legs
- ix. Knees
- x. Feet

These are all physical realities, but there are also abstract boundaries influenced by **politics, culture, society, economy and technology** and a designer's sensibilities, such as how low a neckline on a blouse can and should go.

1. Necklines and collars must be designed to accommodate the neck's natural forward lean and the head's range of motion to prevent constriction.
2. Armhole depth and breadth must incorporate appropriate ease to allow for the desired rotation of the arm around the shoulder pivot point.
3. Bust and back design must account for lung expansion, bust measurements, and the added stress placed across the shoulder blades when arms reach forward.
4. Sleeve design requires darts or added volume at the elbow stress point to facilitate arm bending and movement without compromising the garment's durability or silhouette.
5. Pant rise and crotch depth must accommodate abdominal extension, backside fullness, and the natural spreading of the hips when a person sits or bends.
6. Pant design at the knee requires carefully balancing ease to either maintain a smooth silhouette or intentionally create a bunched, fitted look.
7. Narrow skirts utilize design elements like pleats, slits, or wraps to either permit a full stride or intentionally restrict the wearer's movement.

Fashion figure: A stylized representation of the human body used to show how clothing will look when worn.

The designer must understand where the body bends, where fabric stretches, and where fabric naturally falls. Even when the figure is exaggerated, the garment should still appear believable.

Why does the human body anatomy matters in fashion design

The poor understanding of anatomy can make a fashion illustration (sketch) look stiff or unnatural. Fashion illustration is the art of communicating clothing and style ideas through drawing, painting, or digital media. A fashion sketch of a human figure used as a template for designing clothes is called a croquis.

Understanding anatomy helps the designer:

- i. Draw realistic fashion figures.
- ii. Place garments correctly on the body.
- iii. Understand how seams and darts should work.
- iv. Show correct posture.
- v. Show how clothing responds to body movement.

Some examples include the traditional kimono or Paul Poiret's hobble skirt of the 1910s.



Fashion design and the human body

Clothing is designed to be worn on a moving human body. Therefore, movement should be considered when designing and illustrating garments.

Movement: The way the body and garment change position or shape when the wearer walks, sits, bends, turns, or performs an activity.

Movement can be shown through:

- i. The pose of the fashion figure.
- ii. Direction of the fabric folds.
- iii. Flowing hems.
- iv. Flying scarves.
- v. Draping fabric.
- vi. Raised arms or moving legs.
- vii. Asymmetrical shapes.
- viii. Lines suggesting motion.

A fashion illustration should not always show a stiff standing figure. A walking, turning, or sitting pose can help communicate how the garment behaves in real life.

For example, a flowing chiffon dress can be illustrated with long curved lines to show that the fabric is moving through the air.

Movement is also important for garment function.

A designer should consider:

- i. Can the wearer walk comfortably?
- ii. Can the wearer sit?
- iii. Can the arms move freely?

- iv. Does the fabric restrict movement?
- v. Does the garment return to its shape?
- vi. Is the garment suitable for the activity?

A beautiful garment that cannot be comfortably worn may not be a successful design.

Garment components in Fashion Design

Garments are built from structural parts, design lines, and functional components that work together to shape, fit, and decorate fabric.

Elements of Design

Garment elements are defined by design elements such Color, Line, Shape, Texture and Space which are the elements of design

A. COLOR IN FASHION DESIGN

Color is one of the first things people notice about clothing. It can change the mood, emphasis and visual appearance of a design.

Color is a visual element produced by the way light interacts with a surface.

Importance of color

- i. Creates mood and emotion.
- ii. Attracts attention to particular areas of a garment.
- iii. Helps communicate a theme or concept.
- iv. Can make a garment appear larger or smaller.
- v. Can create harmony or contrast.
- vi. Helps identify cultural and seasonal influences.
- vii. Can influence how the wearer is perceived.

Functions of colour

a) Creates mood because colours can communicate different feelings.

- i. Red can suggest energy, passion or confidence.
- ii. Blue can suggest calmness, trust or coolness.
- iii. Yellow can suggest happiness and brightness.
- iv. Black can suggest elegance, power or seriousness.
- v. White can suggest cleanliness, simplicity or freshness.
- vi. Green can suggest nature, freshness or growth.

However, color meanings can change depending on culture, context and how colours are combined.

b) Creates emphasis

A designer can use a strong or contrasting colour to draw attention to a particular part of a garment. For example, a black dress with a bright red belt immediately draws attention to the waist.

c) Creates harmony

Colours that work well together create visual harmony by colour relations such as the warm and cool colors and colour schemes.

Color schemes

- i. Complementary colours, uses colors opposite each other on the color wheel, such as blue and orange.
- ii. Analogous colours, uses colors that are next to each other on the color wheel, such as blue, blue-green, and green
- iii. Monochromatic colours, uses different shades, tints, and tones of one color.
- iv. Contrast uses the difference between colors, values, textures, or other design elements that makes parts of a design stand out.

Warm and cool colors

- i. Warm colours uses red, orange, and yellow. they can portray energy, warmth, excitement, or confidence.
- ii. Cool colours uses blue, green, and violet. they suggest calmness, freshness, distance, or relaxation.

Neutral colours uses black, white, grey, brown, cream and beige. They provide visual rest, balance, and a sense of timeless elegance

A designer should choose colors according to the purpose of the garment, wearer, occasion, season, and intended mood.

d) Influences perceived size and shape

Dark colours may make an area appear visually smaller, while light or bright colours can make an area appear more noticeable or prominent.

Fashion design application: When analyzing colour in a blue dress, the fashion designer should ask? Why was blue chosen? Where is it placed? Does it create contrast, harmony, emphasis or mood?

FABRIC RENDERING

Fabric rendering means showing the appearance and behavior of different fabrics in a fashion illustration. Different fabrics behave differently; a fashion designer should not draw silk, denim, wool, and chiffon in exactly the texture, weight, shine, thickness, and movement of fabric. This is through same way. Fabric rendering technique is visually representing the line, shading, texture and folds such as:

Silk or satin

- Smooth and shiny.
- Creates strong highlights.
- Usually falls softly.
- Often has flowing folds.

Denim

- Heavier and firmer folds
- Holds its shape.
- Can show visible seams and stitching.
- Usually has a less reflective surface.

Wool

- Often appears thick and warm.

- Has a softer or textured surface.
- Creates heavier folds.

Chiffon

- Very light and transparent.
- Soft folds easily, flowing
- Can create delicate, floating shapes.

Leather

- Usually appears firm and structured.
- Can have strong highlights.
- Folds tend to look heavier and more controlled.

A successful fabric drawing should make the viewer almost feel the material just by looking at the illustration if it is either thick, stiff or soft.

The fashion designers should observe and communicate the following when rendering fabric:

- Weight
- Thickness
- Texture
- Shine
- Transparency
- Direction of folds
- Stretch
- Stiffness
- Movement

Do not draw every fabric in the same way

B. LINE

Line: A visual mark that can guide the viewer's eye and help create the structure of a garment and direction in a design.

Illusion created by types of lines

- Vertical lines can create a sense of length and height.
- Horizontal lines can create a sense of width and stability.
- Diagonal lines can create energy and movement.
- Curved lines can create softness and flow.

Lines can appear through garment elements:

Garment elements directly influence body perception by manipulating structural fit and visual focus. These design tools fall into two functional categories: **Structural Features** (shaping and fit) and **Visual Details** (surface decoration).

1. Structural Features to obtain shaping and fit

- Darts:** Folded and stitched wedges of fabric that shape flat material to curves (shoulder, bust, waist, lower back, elbow and knee).

Body Impact: Essential for Hourglass and Pear frames to prevent waist gapping, but incorrect placement highlights areas intended to be minimized.

- ii. **Pleats:** Folds of fabric doubled back on themselves to add controlled volume and movement.

Body Impact: Adds bulk where placed. Ideal for creating lower-body volume on Inverted Triangle frames, but adds unwanted width around an Apple midsection or wide hips.

- iii. **Seams:** The visible joining lines of fabric pieces (e.g., princess seams, shoulder seams).

Body Impact: Vertical princess seams elongate the torso and pull the waist inward (great for Rectangles and Apples). Misaligned shoulder seams make shoulders look sloped or oversized.

- iv. **Panels:** Distinct sections of fabric sewn together to build a garment (Yoke, godet, gore)

Body Impact: Dark side panels with a lighter center panel create an optical illusion of a narrower midsection, offering instant definition for Rectangle and Apple body types.

- v. **Zips/Buttons :** Fasteners that provide entry while creating clean structural lines.

- vi. **Fasteners:** Functional closures like buttons, zippers, snaps, and hooks used to open and secure a garment.

- vii. **Interfacings and Linings:** Hidden or inner support layers used to add stiffness, structure, or a clean inside finish.

- viii. **Labels and Tapes:** Brand tags, care instructions, and supportive seam binding.

2. Visual Details (surface decoration).

Stripes: Directional line patterns printed or woven into the fabric.

- *Body Impact:* Vertical stripes lengthen and slim the silhouette; horizontal stripes widen. Diagonal stripes create dynamic movement that distracts from asymmetric proportions.

Prints: Flat surface patterns (floral, geometric, abstract).

- *Body Impact:* Scale matters—large, widely spaced prints add visual volume and can overwhelm small frames. Small, dense prints camouflage midsection fullness.

Embroidery: Raised stitch work that adds texture, weight, and visual emphasis.

- *Body Impact:* Draws immediate attention to wherever it is placed. Embroidery around the neck/shoulders lifts focus away from wide hips, while heavy waist embroidery draws attention directly to the midsection.

Garment elements strategically positioned by lines, shapes and proportions of these components control where the eye travels and how body dimensions are perceived.

3. Upper Body & Frame Elements

- **Collar:** The structural band encircling or folding over the neck.

Perception Impact: Frames the face and alters perceived neck length. Pointed collars visually elongate short necks, while spread or mandarin collars add horizontal width to narrow faces.

- **Neckline:** The edge boundary of a garment around the neck and upper chest.

Perception Impact: Directs vertical focus. Deep V-necks and scoop necklines pull attention downward to stretch short torsos; wide horizontal necklines (like boatnecks) broaden narrow shoulders.

- **Shoulder Seam:** The line joining the front and back panels across the top of the shoulder.

Perception Impact: Sets the upper structural width. Standard seams anchored at the shoulder point provide crisp posture; dropped seams widen narrow shoulders, while inset seams narrow broad upper bodies.

4. Central Torso Elements

- **Bodice:** The main section of a garment covering the upper body from shoulders to waist or hips.

Perception Impact: Forms the core silhouette. Contoured, fitted bodices outline natural curves, whereas straight, unshaped bodices minimize midsection definition.

- **Waistline:** The horizontal seam or transition point where the top and bottom sections meet.

Perception Impact: Alters vertical proportions. High (empire) waistlines elongate the legs and conceal midsection fullness, while low-slung waistlines lengthen a short torso.

- **Side Seam:** The vertical seam running along the lateral edge of the torso from armhole to hem.

Perception Impact: Dictates side contouring. Curved side seams pull the waist inward to generate an illusion of curves; straight side seams create a streamlined, boxy profile.

5. Arms & Boundary Elements

- **Sleeve:** The section enclosing all or part of the arm.

Perception Impact: Balances upper-body width. Puffed or cap sleeves broaden narrow shoulders, whereas raglan or dolman sleeves soften broad, athletic upper bodies.

- **Cuff:** The finished band at the end of a sleeve around the wrist or forearm.

Perception Impact: Serves as a focal anchor. Wide or detailed cuffs attract horizontal visual weight to the hips and thighs where arms naturally rest.

- **Hem:** The bottom boundary edge of a top, jacket, skirt, or pant.

Perception Impact: Creates the final horizontal break in an outfit. Hems ending at a body part's widest point (hip, thigh, or calf) accentuate width at that line. Highlight slender legs or balance long torsos.

C. SHAPE AND FORM

Shape refers to two-dimensional areas, while **form** suggests three-dimensional volume.

Shape: A two-dimensional area created by lines, boundaries, or color. Shapes can be geometric, organic, simple, or complex.

In fashion, shapes can be created through:

- i. Cutting.
- ii. Draping.
- iii. Pleating.
- iv. Gathering.
- v. Folding.
- vi. Padding.
- vii. Layering.
- viii. Ruffles.

A designer may manipulate fabric to transform a flat piece of material into a three-dimensional form around the body.

Silhouette

Silhouette is one of the most important aspects of fashion design because it determines the overall shape of a garment.

Silhouette: The outer shape or outline of a garment or figure when viewed as a whole.

Common fashion silhouettes include:

A-line: Narrower at the top and gradually wider toward the hem.

Straight: Falls relatively evenly from the upper body toward the hem.

Fitted: Closely follows the body's shape.

Oversized: Uses extra volume and creates a larger shape around the body.

Hourglass: Emphasizes the shoulders and hips while narrowing the waist.

Empire: Has a raised waistline positioned above the natural waist.

The silhouette should support the purpose of the garment. A dramatic silhouette may be appropriate for a fashion show, while a simpler silhouette may be better for everyday clothing.

D. TEXTURE

Texture in fashion design refers to the surface quality of a garment, which can be experienced through both touch (tactile) and sight (visual). Designers manipulate texture to add depth, affect the garment's silhouette, and influence how light interacts with the fabric. The visual or physical quality of a surface. It describes how a surface looks or feels.

Texture may come from embroidery, lace, pleating, knitting, printing, beads, sequins, or the natural surface of a fabric.

Fashion can contain the following textures:

- i. Smooth VS Rough texture.
- ii. Soft VS Rigid/ stiff texture.
- iii. Shiny VS Matte texture.
- iv. Fuzzy texture.
- v. Metallic texture.
- vi. Embroidered texture.

Texture can add visual interest and can change how a garment is perceived. E.G. a smooth satin evening gown communicates a different feeling from a rough woven wool coat.

E. SPACE

Space: The space is the area in, around, and between a garment and the body wearing it.

The correct use of space prevents a garment from appearing overcrowded.

Space dictates the volume of an outfit, how the fabric interacts with the body, and how the entire look moves through the room. Without space, clothes would just be flat, skin-tight second skins with zero dimension.

The Two main types of space

- **Positive Space:** The actual physical areas taken up by the garment itself. This includes the heavy fabrics, structural boning, layers, ruffles, pleats, and solid design elements.
- **Negative Space:** The empty or unoccupied areas. This includes cutouts that reveal skin, the gap between wide-leg trousers, necklines, and the air trapped between the fabric and your body.

The importance of the element of Space to fashion designers

- It Shapes the silhouette and determines whether an outfit looks sleek and narrow or massive and dramatic
- It Creates visual contrast and alternating between dense positive space (heavy fabric) and open negative space keeps an outfit from looking heavy, messy, or overwhelming.
- It Directs the Eye by clever use of negative space (like a strategic cutout or a deep V-neck) naturally guides where people look first.

PRINCIPLES OF DESIGN

Garment components are guided by design principles such as which Balance, Proportion, Rhythm, Contrast and Harmony

• Proportion in Fashion Design

Proportion describes how individual sections of a design, such as a jacket length versus trouser length relate to each other and the entire silhouette.

Scale relates to the absolute or relative size of specific design details, including patterns, buttons, accessories, and prints, compared to the wearer's body frame.

Size and scale are important aspects of proportion.

Good proportions create visual balance. Poor proportions can make an otherwise good garment look awkward.

Designers sometimes deliberately exaggerate proportions to create a particular artistic effect. This is common in haute couture and experimental fashion.

Example of Proportion in fashion considered are:

- Shoulder width compared with hip width.
- Sleeve length compared with arm length.
- Skirt length compared with the whole body.
- Collar size compared with the neckline.
- Pocket size compared with the garment.

Fashion proportion is not always realistic. Fashion designers sometimes deliberately exaggerate proportions.

For example:

- Extra-long sleeves.
- Very wide shoulders.
- Oversized collars.
- Extremely large pockets.
- Shortened or lengthened garments.

This can create a dramatic or artistic effect. The important point is that the exaggeration should usually look **intentional**, not accidental.

- **Balance:** The distribution of visual weight within a design. Balance can be symmetrical or asymmetrical. **Symmetrical** Both sides are similar or mirrored. **Asymmetrical** The two sides are different, but the design still feels balanced.
- **Rhythm** is the visual movement created by the repeated or patterned arrangement of design elements like lines, colors, shapes, and textures to guide the viewer's eye smoothly across a garment. For example, a designer can achieve this through a row of identical buttons down a dress front (repetition), a gradual shift from light to dark fabric (gradation), or cascading diagonal ruffles that draw attention from the shoulder down to the hem.
- **Contrast:** The deliberate use of differences to create interest and emphasis.

For example, a designer might combine a smooth fabric with a rough textured fabric, or a dark color with a bright color, to create contrast.

- **Harmony:** The pleasing relationship between different elements of a design. Harmony occurs when the colours, fabrics, shapes, proportions and details appear to belong together.

A successful design does not mean that every part must be identical. Different elements can work together while still creating unity.

These principles help prevent a design from looking random.

Significance Art Fundamentals Help a Fashion Designer

Art-based knowledge allows designers to:

1. Develop stronger fashion illustrations.
2. Select appropriate colors.
3. Understand how garments fit the body.
4. Represent different fabrics realistically.
5. Create attractive silhouettes.
6. Show movement in clothing.
7. Improve proportion and balance.
8. Communicate design ideas clearly.
9. Create visually interesting collections.
10. Develop an individual design style.

Fashion design combines creativity with technical understanding. A designer who understands art fundamentals can make better decisions about color, fabric, proportion, silhouette, texture, and movement.

The strongest fashion designs do not simply look beautiful. They communicate an idea and show a clear understanding of the human body, materials, construction, and visual principles.

PROCESSES TO FOLLOW AND ANALYSE THE USE OF ART FUNDAMENTALS IN FASHION DESIGN

Step 1: Observe

Look at the whole design before focusing on details.

Step 2: Identify

Identify the colour, fabric, silhouette, lines, shapes, proportions and details.

Step 3: Analyze

Ask how these elements work together.

Step 4: Interpret

Think about the mood, message, wearer and occasion.

Step 5: Evaluate

Decide what works well and what could be improved.

HOW TO DESCRIBE FASHION DESIGN ANALYSIS

A good fashion design analysis of a long black evening dress made from satin with a fitted waist and flowing skirt would be as follows:

The aim is to explain **how and why the design elements work**. Don't simply say this is stronger than simply say "It is a black dress."

The black colour creates an elegant and formal mood. The satin fabric gives the garment a smooth and reflective appearance. The fitted waist creates an hourglass effect, while the flowing skirt introduces movement. The contrast between the fitted upper section and fuller lower section creates visual interest. The long silhouette also gives the design a sense of length and sophistication.

Fashion design analysis, check points

- Have I discussed the colour?
- Have I explained the silhouette?
- Have I considered the human body?
- Have I identified the fabric and its behaviour?
- Have I discussed proportion?
- Have I explained movement?
- Have I mentioned important lines, shapes or textures?

- Have I explained the mood or message of the design?
- Have I supported my observations with reasons?

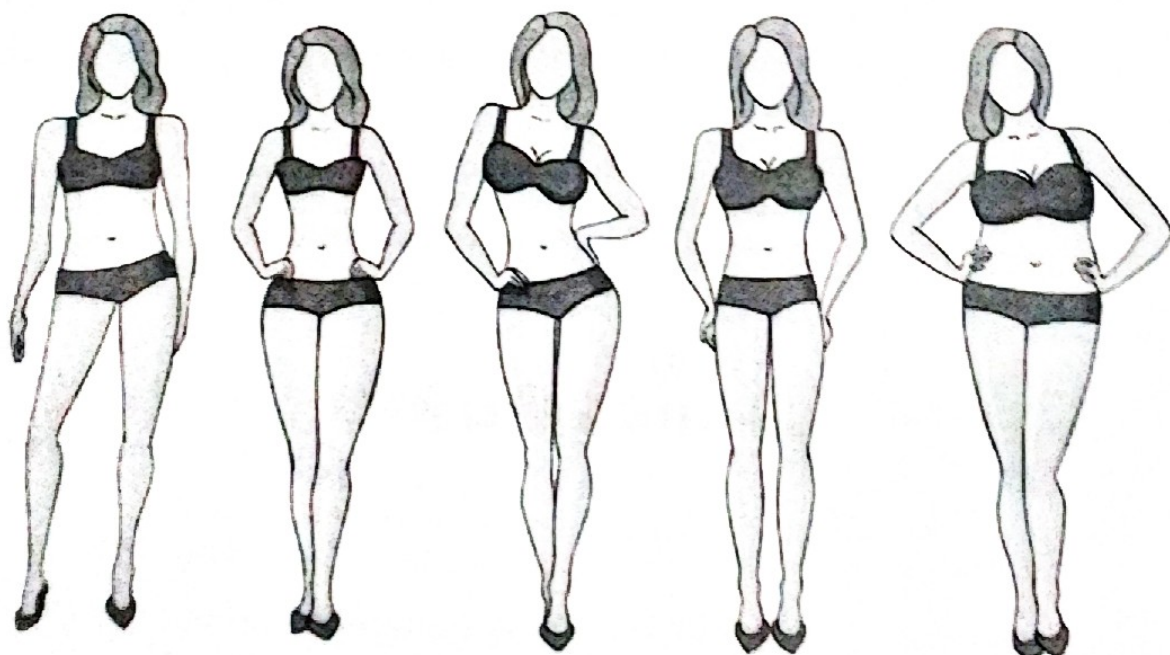
To be successful fashion designers the following should be noted:

1. Colour communicates mood, emphasis and identity.
2. Anatomy helps the designer understand how clothing relates to the body.
3. Fabric rendering communicates weight, texture, shine and movement.
4. Silhouette is the overall shape of the garment.
5. Proportion describes the relationship between different parts.
6. Movement shows how the garment behaves when worn.
7. Line creates direction, structure and visual flow.
8. Texture adds surface interest.
9. Balance and harmony help different design elements work together.
10. A good fashion interpretation explains **what we see, how it works and why it matters.**

CLOTHING SELECTION AND BODY TYPE ISSUES

Dressing effectively relies on proportion, balance, and fit. Standard mass-produced garments are built on idealized size templates, creating common fit issues across different natural body shapes.

Common female body types, clothing issues and possible solutions



rectangle

triangle

hourglass

inverted
triangle

round

A. Pear (Triangle)

Characteristics: Hips and thighs are wider than the shoulders and bust.

- Fit Issues:
 - i. Waist Gap: Trousers sized for the hips are often too loose around the waist.
 - ii. Size Discrepancy: Different top and bottom sizes make sets and dresses difficult off-the-rack.
- Clothing Goal: Add volume to the upper body; streamline the lower body.

B. Inverted Triangle

Characteristics: Broad shoulders and full bust with narrow hips.

- Fit Issues:
 - i. Jackets and tops fit the shoulders but are too loose at the waist.
 - ii. Shoulder pads or puff sleeves create an overly broad look.
- Clothing Goal: Soften shoulder lines and add visual weight to the hips (e.g., A-line skirts, wide-leg trousers).

C. Rectangle (Banana / Athletic)

Characteristics: Shoulders, waist, and hips are roughly equal in width.

- Fit Issues:
 - i. Boxy cuts make the torso appear rigid and shapeless.
 - ii. Garments lack natural waist definition.
- Clothing Goal: Create the illusion of curves using belts, peplums, or structured waistlines.

D. Apple (Oval / Round)

Characteristics: Weight is concentrated around the midsection; slender legs and arms.

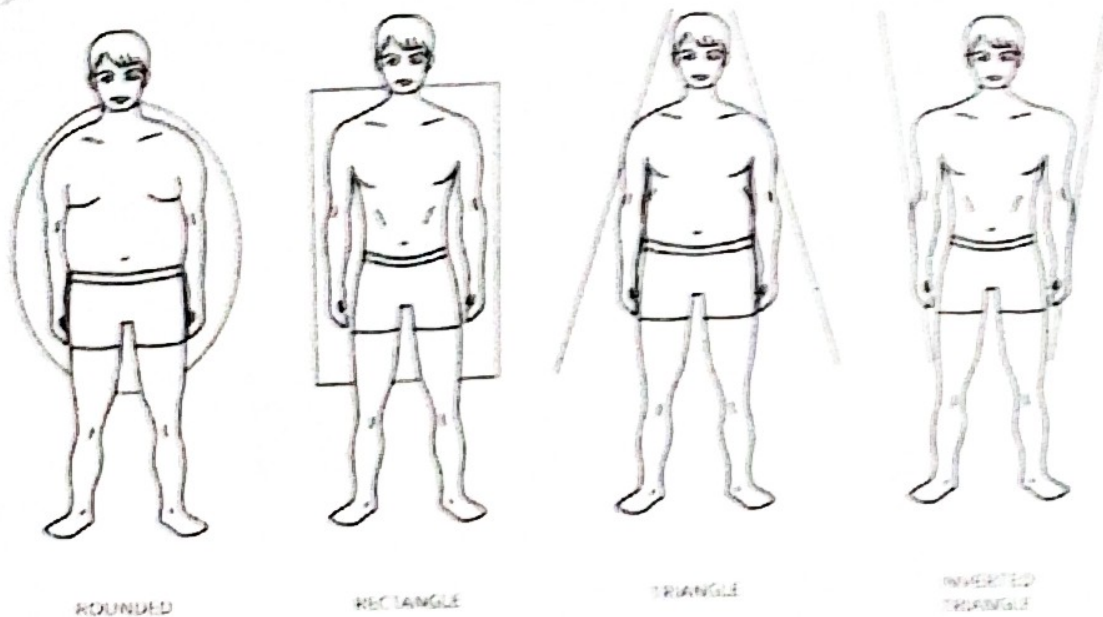
- Fit Issues:
 - i. Fitted shirts cling uncomfortably around the abdomen.
 - ii. Baggy clothing conceals slim limbs, making the frame look larger overall.
- Clothing Goal: Draw attention upward toward the face and chest; use structured, empire, or wrap cuts.

E. Hourglass

Characteristics: Bust and hips are balanced with a significantly narrower, defined waist.

- Fit Issues:
 - i. Unstructured or loose clothing hides the waist, creating a bulky silhouette.
 - ii. Tailored shirts often pull at the bust while remaining loose at the midsection.
- Clothing Goal: Preserve natural waist definition with fitted styles, wrap dresses, and tailored seams.

Common male body types, clothing issues and possible solutions



A. Inverted Triangle (Athletic / Broad)

Characteristics: Broad chest and shoulders with a narrow waist and hips.

- Fit Issues:
 - i. Regular-fit dress shirts bag around the stomach when sized for the shoulders.
 - ii. Slim-fit trousers can be overly tight around developed thighs.
- Clothing Goal: Wear tailored or athletic-fit tops; balance the lower half with straight-leg trousers.

B. Trapezoid (Balanced / Standard Ideal)

Characteristics: Broad shoulders, medium chest, and a slightly narrower waist.

- Fit Issues:
 - i. Out-of-the-box standard sizing generally fits well, though sleeve lengths and trouser hems still vary.
- Clothing Goal: Focus on clean tailoring without over-complicating proportions.

C. Rectangle (Tall / Lean)

Characteristics: Shoulders, chest, waist, and hips are aligned straight down.

- Fit Issues:
 - i. Vertical stripes and flat, dark colors make the frame look excessively thin or tall.
 - ii. Shirts can hang loosely without defining structure.
- Clothing Goal: Add structure through layering, horizontal patterns, and double-breasted jackets.

D. Triangle (A-Frame)

Characteristics: Narrower shoulders with hips and waist wider than the chest.

Fit Issues:

- i. Polo shirts and soft tees emphasize the slope of the shoulders.
- ii. Tapered trousers accentuate wider hips.
- Clothing Goal: Use structured shoulder jackets to broaden the upper body; wear straight-leg pants.

F. Oval / Round

- Characteristics: Torso is wider at the center, with softer shoulders and necklines.

Fit Issues:

- i. Belts can pinch or slip under the midsection.
 - ii. Tight button-downs gape at the stomach.
- Clothing Goal: Choose clean, vertical lines, dark monochrome shades, and structured blazers to elongate the frame.

Key factors in garment Fit

Issue Factor	Problem Area	Solution / Correction
Fabric Selection	Stiff fabrics add bulk; thin knits cling to problem spots.	Use medium-weight fabrics that drape smoothly over the frame.
Patterns & Lines	Bold horizontal lines broaden areas; vertical lines lengthen.	Place patterns strategically to draw eyes toward balanced features.
Sizing Standardization	Off-the-rack clothes use fixed proportions that do not fit all body types.	Tailor garments at stress points (waist, shoulders, hem lengths).

TAKE AWAY INDIVIDUAL ASSIGNMENT

Define the **Garment elements** that directly influence body perception by manipulating structural fit and visual focus listed below. The garment is made up of several design areas, such as:

- Neckline
- Collar
- Shoulder
- Sleeve
- Bodice
- Waistline
- Dart
- Seam
- Pocket
- Placket
- Skirt
- Trouser leg
- Hemline
- Fastenings
- Pleats and gathers
- Closure
- Yoke
- Panel
- Gore
- Godet

Garment Anatomy

Draw and label the major parts of a garment i.e. shirt, blouse, skirt, short, trouser. Explain the function of each part.

Group class assignments — 10 groups

Group	Assignment	What to present
1	Color in Fashion	Explain color theory and create 3 fashion looks using different color schemes.
2	Garment Anatomy	Draw and label the major parts of a garment. Explain the function of each part.
5	Fashion Silhouettes	Research and draw at least 6 silhouettes, explaining the shape and effect of each.
6	Proportion in Fashion	Show examples of good and exaggerated proportions and explain how they affect a design.
8	Line, Shape & Texture	Create fashion designs demonstrating different lines, shapes, and surface textures.
9	Balance, Harmony & Contrast	Produce 3 outfits showing balance, harmony, and contrast, and explain the design decisions.
10	Complete Fashion Interpretation	Select one fashion design and analyze its color, anatomy, fabric, silhouette, proportion, texture, and movement.

For every group: Include drawings/illustrations, explanations, and practical examples rather than only reading definitions. Each group should have all members participate in the presentation.